anguish and pain, it would also severely strain his already stressed financial resources.



Even as VOC was putting in his papers, on 8 June, the SSNCo's directors met but this time at Tirunelveli rather than at Tuticorin, the company's headquarters. The change in venue is indicative of the rumblings within the management. While Tuticorin was the epicentre of VOC's influence, the team of directors who had ganged up against VOC was based in Tirunelveli. While the meeting was chaired by A. Sundara Sastri, those present included S.S.V. Krishna Pillai and S.T.A. Arumugam Pillai—other names are not known. At this meeting, it was formally resolved to double the authorized capital to Rs 20 lakh. Other resolutions passed were of a technical nature—we are unable to make sense of these resolutions without access to all the documents or their context. With barely a week left for the annual general meeting, the directors announced that the new points of agenda would be shared through the press such as *Swadesamitran* and *The Hindu*.[18] This was probably a ploy to keep some matters under wraps, and away from the knowledge of shareholders who might not have taken the resignation of VOC's removal lightly.

In the event, the shareholders' meeting could not be held on 26 June; it was postponed again, this time by a week, for reasons that are not clear.[19] Evidently there were serious differences among the directors. 'Although a fairly large number of shareholders from various places, far and near were present', *The Hindu* reported, 'many of the proxies had to be taken as invalid, they having not been received at the Company's office 72 hours before the meeting as required by the Articles of Association.'[20] Consequently, the shareholders' meeting did not take place but the directors met informally. It was more than clear that the directors were divided down the middle.[21] What was at stake was the future of the company: to be or not to be was the question.